



Jazz Forms — the cheat sheet

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The five shapes behind most standards. One chorus = once through the whole form.

32-BAR AABA · HALF THE GREAT AMERICAN SONGBOOK

A home — the statement (8 bars)

A home again (8)

B THE BRIDGE — away on purpose (8)

A home, and it means more (8)

RHYTHM CHANGES — A SECTION (B-FLAT) · TURNAROUND CHAINS

Bb G7 I VI	Cm7 F7 ii V	Bb G7 I VI	Cm7 F7 ii V
Fm7 Bb7 to IV	Eb Edim IV #IVd	Bb/F G7 I VI	Cm7 F7 ii V

RHYTHM CHANGES — BRIDGE · DOMINANTS FALLING IN FIFTHS, 2 BARS EACH

D7 III7	G7 VI7	C7 II7	F7 V7
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Oleo, Anthropology, Cotton Tail — hundreds of bebop heads use exactly these changes.

THE OTHERS

- ABAC (32): statement / answer / statement / DIFFERENT answer — Fly Me to the Moon, But Not for Me.
- Jazz blues (12): see the blues cheat sheet — first soloing form for most students.
- Modal (So What, 32 AABA): D dorian 16 · Eb dorian 8 · D dorian 8. Two chords, nowhere to hide.
- Minor blues (12): i7 / iv7 / bVI7-V7 — The Thrill Is Gone, Mr. P.C.

THE ENGINE INSIDE ALL OF THEM

ii-V-I: **Dm7 -> G7 -> Cmaj7** each 7th falls a half-step to the next 3rd

Turnaround: **I - VI7 - ii - V7** tritone sub: **V7 -> bII7 (D-Db-C bassline)**